Environment and International Relations

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The Earth Day (April 22) and the World Environment Day (June 5) are celebrated every year, all around the globe, to raise awareness about environmental problems and to work for a more concerted action towards tackling them. But the question is, how far is the world community aware of the challenges to the environment? As discussed in Chapter 4 under the section on sustainable development, the environment has been a prime concern of international community for a long time. With the onset of globalization, growth of market economy and technological revolution, the global environment, especially that of the developing countries, stands threatened. Therefore, time has come to rethink about international relations and its connection with the environment. The noteworthy initiative that was taken by the international community to voice their environmental concerns was the Stockholm Conference (1972) on Environment under the auspices of the United Nations. Since then, a number of summits and conferences have been held and a number of conventions have been passed to sensitize the states and the world population about the environmental problems such as global warming, climate change, pollution (air, water and sound) and sustainable development.